CHAPTER 43

2015 ASHES BROAD SPELL

6–8 August 2015

ENGLAND vs AUSTRALIA, 4th Test, *Trent Bridge, Nottingham*

Australia 60 and 253; England 391/9 dec.

England won by an innings and 78 runs

Australia 1st innings: **S Broad 8–15**

It's a year later – the Trent Bridge Ashes Test. I'm miserable to be sitting it out. At Edgbaston, I've bowled really well and felt brilliant before, in the second innings, I experience my side tug as I run into bowl. I tell no one and run back in. At the exact same point of the delivery stride it does so again, only worse. I tell Broady, stationed at mid-on. I say I can bowl on. He gives me a look, the one that only him and Cooky have licence to, and tells me not to. 'You'll make it much worse,' he says, with a logic I don't want to hear but know I need to listen to.

The pitch is green – sickeningly green. I would have loved bowling on it. It does something horrible to me to miss out on cricket now – like every time my body pulls up, I feel the volume of the doubters – of the people waiting for my career to end – turned up. It causes me to question my own sanity.

The conditions are perfect for Broady. Chris Rogers: perfect line and length, caught Cooky. Smith: squared up in the same over, caught Root. Shaun Marsh: caught driving by Ian Bell. 15/4. Adam Voges: huge outside edge, Ben Stokes, diving full length to his right, plucking it out of the air in a moment of magic. 21/5. Broad is running towards Stokes, his hands over